"My feelings are facts."

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Where it often comes from

Strong emotions feel like truth. When anxious or depressed, thoughts like "I am in danger" or "I am worthless" feel certain. Without distance, we act on feelings as though they were reality.

What Scripture teaches

"The heart is deceitful above all things and beyond cure" (Jeremiah 17:9), and Proverbs warns, "There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death." Paul says, "Be transformed by the renewing of your mind." "We take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ" (2 Corinthians 10:5). Feelings are real and important data, but they are not always accurate reports. David talked to his own soul, asking why it was downcast and telling it to put its hope in God (Psalm 42:5). We can feel and still ask, "Is it true?"

> *"Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence"* (Psalm 42:5).

Also see

> "We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ" (2 Corinthians 10:5).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death" (Proverbs 14:12).

> "Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things" (Philippians 4:8).

Common self-statements

- If I feel it, it must be true.
- I feel worthless, so I am.
- I feel doomed, so I am.
- My feelings never lie.
- Questioning them is denying them.
- My gut is always right.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing feelings are always true or always false.
- Fortune telling: Predicting based on how I feel.
- Emotional reasoning: Treating feelings as facts.
- Emotional reasoning: Calling a feeling a fact.

Challenging questions

- What exactly am I feeling, and what thought goes with it?
- What evidence supports and challenges that thought?

- Has a strong feeling been wrong before?
- What would I say if my soul were a friend?
- What does Scripture say about thoughts and the mind?
- Who can help me test my thoughts?

Truth summary

> My feelings are real, but they are not always accurate. I can name them, test the thoughts attached to them, and speak truth to my own soul, as David did.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Thinking, Healthy
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My feelings are facts"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My feelings are facts." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly am I feeling, and what thought goes with it?
- ☐ What evidence supports and challenges that thought?
- ☐ Has a strong feeling been wrong before?
- ☐ What would I say if my soul were a friend?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about thoughts and the mind?
- ☐ Who can help me test my thoughts?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Feelings are real, not always right.
- ☐ I can ask, "Is it true?"
- ☐ I can renew my mind.
- ☐ I can take thoughts captive.
- ☐ I can talk to my soul.
- ☐ Hope in God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 42:5
  "Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 10:5
  "We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Feeling and fact: Each day, write one feeling, the thought, and a truer thought.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 42:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can feel deeply and still ask whether it is true.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Thinking, Unhealthy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Name the feeling. Write it plainly.
- ☐ Test the thought. Ask for evidence for and against.
- ☐ Speak to your soul. Say Psalm 42:5 aloud.
- ☐ Share. Talk through it with a counselor or friend.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My feelings are facts": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Feeling and fact
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My feelings are facts.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my feelings are strong. Help me notice them, test them, and hold fast to Your truth. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.